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A Study of Environmental Moral Reasoning of Prospective Teachers

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Abstract : Earth is the only planet known to us where life is possible till now. Definitely because the way we are destroying the environment in the name of development is leading us towards our own extinction. The present study is conducted to find out the status of environmental moral reasoning among prospective teachers to know whether this factor contributes to our different attitude of students towards environment. The descriptive survey method was used to do the study by taking both male & female students of B.Ed. from both arts & science streams. Simple random sampling method was used to select the sample. The result of the study reflects us for an environmental moral reasoning is concerned female students have shown more concern as compared to male students and their mean scores differ significantly also. It means that the science stream students have more moral reasoning for environment than art stream students. This may be reflect that more exposure to science education bring development of scientific attitude towards environment. It helps them to get worry for environment.

Key Words: Environmental Moral Reasoning, Prospective Teachers.

Introduction : The major issue before every human being on this earth be it policy maker, political leader, educationist, scientist, environmentalist, sociologist etc or even a common person is one and only one & that is Protection of Environment. But our environment is being depleted day by day through the misuse of scientific and technological developments and also due to lack of proper awareness regarding the environmental management.

We spend a lot of money & time in the name of environment still various issues that are haunting our life and they are different types of pollution, deforestation, wildlife depletion, desertification, global warming, ozone layer depletion, biosphere management, green house effect etc. As human beings are living in an ecosystem, where interaction of living species, non-living species, with their environment takes place so any change happens in their environment affect them. When acid rain falls over an area, it can kill trees, harm animals, fish and other wild life. It can change the chemical nature of soil and water. Even several species of plants and animals have already vanished from the earth and many are on the verge of extinction. WHO (World Health Organisation) estimates that about a quarter of diseases facing mankind today occur due to prolonged exposure to environment pollution.

Young (2002) said that in order to find solutions to the environmental problems, one of the prerequisites is creating changes in behaviors of people.

Many research studies have been done to identify the factors that have influence on people's environmental behavior. After identifying the research findings, it is seen that among the factors related to environmental behaviors, ethics and values are frequently highlighted. Environmental moral reasoning is one of the important aspects to find out the reason behind individual's awareness towards importance & protection of environment.

Environmental Moral Reasoning: Ethics are a broad way of thinking about what constitutes a good life and how to live one. They address questions of right and wrong, making good decisions, and the character or attributes necessary to live a good life. Applied ethics address these issues with a special emphasis on how they can be lived out in a practical manner. Environmental ethics apply ethical thinking to the natural world and the relationship between humans and the earth.

In the most general sense, environmental ethics invites us to consider three key propositions:

1. The Earth and its creatures have moral status, in other words, are worthy of our ethical concern;

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